

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 9 6 4  
♥ J 7 3  
♦ 10 5 2  
♣ 5 2

♠ 7 5

♥ K 6 4

♦ K Q 7 4

♣ J 9 8 6

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ Q 10 3

♥ Q 9 5

♦ J 9 8 6

♣ A 7 3

♠ A 8 2

♥ A 10 8 2

♦ A 3

♣ K Q 10 4

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       |      | 1NT   |
| Pass     | 2NT   | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

3NT by South  
continuation. You win the third ♠ with your ♠A.

Partner's 2NT bid invites you to bid game if you have a maximum hand. Your 17 points is certainly a maximum so you bid 3NT.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠6. Will you take your ♠A immediately? or at trick 2? or trick 3?

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 6

You need 3 more tricks, and they must come from ♣s. So you must drive out the ♣A. The problem is that when the defenders win the ♣A they may also take 4 ♠ tricks.

While you cannot guarantee the contract you can at least give yourself a better chance by holding up your ♠A on the first trick, and also on East's ♠.

Now you drive out the ♣A. There are four possibilities: West may win the ♣A and cash two more ♠s, down 1. West may win the ♣A and cash just one ♠s, you make it. East may win the ♣A and have a fourth ♠ to lead, you make it. East may win the ♣A and be out of ♠s, you make it.

If you win the first or second ♠ trick you will fail. When you attack ♣s, East will win the ♣A and play a ♠.

Holding up twice can never hurt, and in this case it is the only way to make the contract.

**Board 3**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q 3  
 ♥ K 7 5 3  
 ♦ 10 8  
 ♣ K 10 6 2

♠ J 9 8 6 4 2

♥ 4

♦ K 6 5 3

♣ 8 3



♠ K 7  
 ♥ J 10 9 8  
 ♦ J 9 7 2  
 ♣ Q 9 5

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q 6 2

♦ A Q 4

♣ A J 7 4

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       |      | 1NT   |
| Pass     | 2♥    | Pass | 2♠    |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

2♠ by South

5Count losers in the long-trump hand, (dummy this time).

In the pre-transfer days you would have bid 2♠ with this hand and partner would have passed. Now you make partner bid the ♠s first by saying 2♥. Partner dutifully replies 2♠.

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You say pass.

The contract would be 2♠ played by North.

South plays 2♠. West leads the ♣2. East plays the ♣Q which you take with your ♣A.

Loser List: ♠ = 3 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total =

You can make the contract if you just force out their big trumps. But there is another tempting possibility. You could enter dummy with the ♦K and play the ♥4, finessing East for the ♥K. If the finesse is successful you could then discard dummy's ♣ loser on the ♥A.

Should you or shouldn't you?

The reward for this play would be an overtrick. The price of failure would be going down in a cold contract. So obviously, at rubber bridge, you would be foolish to take such a risk. Playing Duplicate though, you **might** consider it. But let's say you decide to play safe.

Win the ♣A and play a trump. As soon as you get in play another trump. The defenders will no doubt take their ♣ winner when they get in. East will no doubt win one of those high trump tricks, and he MAY lead a ♥ when he gets in. There you will be, trying to decide again whether to finesse . . .

As you see, the ♥K is in the wrong place this time, but might be right the next time.

Usually you should not risk your contract for the sake of an overtrick.

**Board 5**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 8 7 3

♥ 6 4 2

♦ 9 5

♣ Q 9 5

♠ J 4

♥ A 9 8 5

♦ J 10 7 3

♣ K 8 2



♠ A 9 2

♥ J 10 7 3

♦ A 6 4

♣ J 6 3

♠ K 6 5

♥ K Q

♦ K Q 8 2

♣ A 10 7 4

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       |      | 1NT   |
| Pass     | 2♣    | Pass | 2♦    |
| Pass     | 2NT   | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

3NT by South

You need 3 more tricks, and they must come from ♦s. So you must drive out the ♦A. The problem is that when the defenders win the ♦A they may also take 4 ♠ tricks.

This is another case where you should hold up. Allow EW to win the second trick and take your ♠K only at trick #3.

Now you drive out the ♦A. If West has it and also started with 5 ♠s you will go down. But if East has the ♦A you will make the contract no matter how ♠s split.

If you win the second ♠ East will still have a ♠ when he wins the ♦A.

But if you hold up your ♠K East will have no ♠ to put his partner in with.

Partner's 2♣ is Stayman convention. With no 4-card Major suit your response is 2♦. Partner now bids 2NT.

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The 2NT bid is invitational, asking you to bid game with a maximum, pass with a minimum. You have 17 points so you bid 3NT.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠7. You put on dummy's ♠J, but East wins the ♠A then continues with the ♠9. Do you play your ♠K now?

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 6